4 In listing the books year by year, I will number them so as to give a running total of all of them. Those who question me about my books never ask how many I have published "this year"; they always want to know the overall total.

There were explanations, of course. The time I had spent on the textbook and on the layman's biochemistry book had been enormous and had brought me in nothing. Nevertheless, I felt a little shaken in my belief that I could support myself by my writing if I had to.

As invariably happened, the new year brought my birthday, my first as a father, and on January 2, 1952,1 was thirty-two years old.

Events are no respecters of birthdays. On January 4, I heard from Howard Browne. He rejected "King Lear IV, I, 36" but, rather to my surprise, told me he was accepting "What if—/' the story I had written in response to Gertrude's question about where I got my ideas.

Then, on January 9, the galleys of Biochemistry and Human Metabolism began to come in in three copies plus a master.

What we did was this: Each of us—Walker, Boyd, and I— searched our own copies for mistakes. We then foregathered. The author of that chapter would list the corrections and they would be entered in the master. Each of the other two would then add any other corrections he had found. Invariably, no one of us caught all the errors. Always, No. 2 could add to what No. 1 could find, and then No. 3 would come along with something both the others had missed. And on a surprising number of occasions, there were mistakes none of us found.

The publisher's proofreader himself searched for mistakes and would point out inconsistencies in capitalization, hyphenation, and so on. It was a dreadful chore to try to decide on consistency, especially when the three of us never agreed. Finally Bill Boyd said, "According to Emerson, 'A foolish consistency is the hobgoblin of little minds.'"

After that whenever we came to a trivial inconsistency, we would chorus "Emerson!" and let it stand.

The official notification that I was Assistant Professor having come on January 22, that was entered in place of "Instructor" on the title page of the textbook. That gave me enormous satisfaction.

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